

Psychology
Higher level and standard level
Paper 1

Specimen paper

1 hour 30 minutes

Instructions to candidates

- Do not open this examination paper until instructed to do so.
- Section A: answer both questions.
- Section B: answer both questions.
- Section C: answer one question.
- The maximum mark for this examination paper is **[35 marks]**.

Section A

Answer **both** questions from this section.

Biological approach to understanding human behaviour

1. Describe how **one** chemical messenger plays a role in **one** human behaviour. [4]

Cognitive approach to understanding human behaviour

2. Explain anchoring bias with reference to **one** example of human behaviour. [4]

Section B

Answer **both** questions from this section.

Context: Learning and cognition

3. A group of researchers investigated imagination as a cognitive process. They suggested a model in which imagination consists of three stages of processing:

- Selection of elements
- Random combination of elements with each other
- Evaluation of combinations and output

To test this model, they conducted a study with a sample of primary school children. Each child was given a set of toy body parts (for example, tails, feet, hair, wings) and asked to create an imaginary creature. Researchers observed that children first selected a subset of body parts then spent time randomly combining them with each other, before deciding on a final version and presenting it to the researchers.

With reference to this study, explain the value of cognitive models for understanding cognitive processes. [6]

Context: Human development

4. As the school psychologist, you have been asked to suggest a strategy to promote empathy **and/or** prosocial behaviour among children at your school.

Explain how social learning theory could be used to achieve this goal. [6]

Section C

Answer **one** question from this section.

5. In the context of **human development**, evaluate **one or more** strategies used by developmental psychologists to **measure** theory of mind. [15]
6. One claim in the psychology of **health and well-being** is that a single **perspective** is not enough to explain mental health. Discuss this claim with reference to **one** biological explanation of **one or more** disorders. [15]
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